30

Its name was Rancho del Cielo, although it was called Tip Top Ranch the first day we saw it.

After I became governor and taxes forced us to sell our ranch near Lake Malibu, Nancy and I purchased a large piece of land in an isolated rural area north of San Diego, planning to make it our ranch-hideaway once I left office. Although there was no utility service on the property when we bought it, we were assured water and electrical service would be extended there shortly. But as the time approached for us to leave Sacramento, there was still no utility service and we were told none was likely to be provided very soon.

When one of our friends, Bill Wilson, heard about our problem, he said he had heard rumors that a cattle ranch not far from a lemon ranch he owned north of Santa Barbara might be coming on the market and he offered to find out if we could visit it. We'd been at his ranch many times as guests and loved the area, but didn't know what we were getting ourselves in for.

Bill and his wife, Betty, and Nancy and I got in Bill's car and we started driving up a narrow, winding road into the Santa Ynez mountains, a range of granite peaks that rise above the Pacific Ocean a few miles north of Santa Barbara.

The road seemed to go on forever and as we got higher and higher up the mountain, Betty started saying, "Bill, there can't be anything up here that they'd want, why don't you turn around?" But Bill didn't answer and kept on driving.

Although I kept quiet, I was beginning to have the same doubts as Betty: The road was so steep and the area was so primitive I thought, well, maybe somebody's got a house up